



AFRICA ECONOMIC FORUM 2026



Africa & Global Realignments:

Investments,
Alliances &
Strategic Opportunities

10-11 NOVEMBER 2026
KINSHASA, DRC

A Message from the Host

In a world shifting towards new geopolitical alliances and economic realignments, Africa must no longer be a passive observer. The Africa Economic Forum emerges as the continent's premier platform for high-level strategic dialogue and actionable investments.

We are not gathering merely to talk – we are here to connect ministers with markets, innovators with investors, and bold ideas with the capital they need to scale.

Kinshasa – a city at the heart of Africa's next chapter.

A meeting point for leaders, capital and ideas. A place to shape partnerships that matter.

Welcome to Kinshasa.

Welcome to Africa's Davos.

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Dr. Billy Issa". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the "Dr." in a smaller, more formal script and "Billy Issa" in a larger, more expressive cursive.

Visionary Founder,
Africa Economic Forum



ABOUT THE AFRICA ECONOMIC FORUM

As an architect of economic and influence ecosystems, we support governments in designing and implementing strategies for economic, diplomatic, and territorial attractiveness—with a clear goal: to attract investment and position their territory as a hub for regional or continental growth.

WHY ATTEND?

High-Impact Networking: AI-powered matchmaking for investors, startups, and policymakers.

Deal Flows: Pre-vetted projects, MoU signings, and sovereign fund pitches.

Geopolitical Insights: Learn how Africa can leverage US-China-Gulf dynamics.

Exclusive Access: Closed-door roundtables with ministers, CEOs, and global investors.



KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- Diplomatic Breakfast: Ministers & CEOs in 1:1 deal sessions.
- Africa-Gulf Investment Pipeline: curated high-impact projects.
- Currency Wars Panel: Gold-backed trade frameworks discussed.
- Tech Sovereignty Debate: Africa-Gulf fintech partnerships explored.

WHY SPONSOR?

1. Position Your Brand at the Center of Africa's Economic Future
2. Access High-Impact Decision-Makers
3. Shape the Global Conversation on Africa
4. Exclusive Deal Flow & Investment Insights
5. Showcase Your Commitments to ESG and Africa's Rise



PROGRAM AGENDA – DAY 1

08:00 – 09:00

Welcome & Strategic Networking

Diplomatic Breakfast: Ministers, Gulf investors, and CEOs meet in curated 1:1 sessions.

Deal Matchmaking : AI-powered app to connect attendees based on investment interests (e.g., tech, energy, infrastructure).

09:00 – 10:30

Opening Session: Africa in the Geopolitics of Investment

Theme : How Africa Can Leverage US-China-Gulf Rivalries for Capital Flows

Moderator: (Economic Strategist, Africa Advisors).

Speakers:

- Post-2024 US investor sentiment on Africa.
- Dubai as Africa's deal-making hub.
- Avoiding debt traps, attracting equity.
- Africa's tech unicorn potential.

Action : Launch of the "Africa-Gulf Investment Pipeline" (a pre-vetted portfolio of 50 high-impact projects).

10:30 – 12:00

Panel 1 : Currency Wars & Financial Sovereignty

Theme: Dollar, Yuan, Crypto: How Africa Can Hedge Risks

Speakers:

- Gold & tangible assets.
- Blockchain for African currencies.
- Development banks' role.

Deal Component:

- Roundtable : African central banks × Gulf sovereign funds on gold-backed trade frameworks.

12:00 – 14:00

VIP Luncheon : Closed-Door Deal Tables

- 10 curated roundtables (e.g., "Tech Exit Strategies", "Infrastructure PPPs") with CEOs and ministers.

- Pitch Zone: 5-minute startup pitches to Gulf sovereign funds (judged by leading investors and venture funds).

14:00 – 15:30

Panel 2 : Technology & Digital Sovereignty

Theme: Can Africa Bypass Western Tech Giants?

Speakers:

- Local vs global tech dominance.
- Patient capital for startups.
- Why Silicon Valley bets on Africa.

Deal Component:

- MoU Signing: African fintechs

15:00 – 17:00

Panel 3: Energy & New Alliances

Theme: Oil, Green Gas, Nuclear: Who Will Fund Africa's Transition?

Speakers:

- Fossil fuels vs renewables.
- Africa's natural gas race.
- Solar partnerships.

Deal Component:

- Live Auction : 3 African renewable energy projects bid on

17:00 – 18:30

The Grand African Deal

Keynote:

- Industrialization & self-reliance.

Announcements:

1. Africa-Gulf Infrastructure Fund: a flagship strategic investment initiative.
2. "Deal Room" Results: Live announcement of deals concluded during the event.

18:30 – 21:00

Celebration & Closed-Door Signings

- Deal Room Stays Open : Final negotiations with notaries on-site.
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- Performance : a renowned African artist (TBC).

PROGRAM AGENDA – DAY 2

08:00 – 09:00

Sector-Specific Breakfasts

- Agriculture: Hosted by
- Critical Minerals: Hosted by
- Health: Hosted by
- Infrastructure: Hosted by
- Tourism: Hosted by

09:00 – 10:30

Plenary : Intra-African Trade Revolution

Moderator :

Speakers:

- Pan-African payment systems
- Border modernization
- Digital trade corridors

Deal : Launch of Africa Trade Gateway digital platform

10:30 – 12:00

Parallel Sector Sessions

AGRICULTURE & AGRI-TECH

Theme : "Feeding 2 Billion by 2050"

Speakers:

- Climate-smart agriculture
- Gulf-Africa partnerships
- Vanilla & spice value chains

Deal : **\$200M** agri-processing zone announcement

CRITICAL MINERALS

Theme : "From Extraction to Batteries"

Speakers:

- Lithium processing
 - Local value addition
 - Processing joint ventures
- Deal: Rare earths refinery MoU

HEALTH SOVEREIGNTY

Theme : "Vaccines to Pharma 4.0"

Speakers:

- Manufacturing partnerships
- mRNA tech transfer
- Vaccine logistics hubs

Deal : African mRNA consortium launch

INFRASTRUCTURE

Theme : "Connecting the Next 500 Million"

Speakers:

- Desert-to-power initiative
- Port modernization
- Belt & Road 2.0

Deal : Trans-African rail feasibility signing

TOURISM

Theme : "Luxury Safari to Space Tourism"

Speakers:

- Visa-free Africa
- Future tourism trends
- Island resort investments

Deal : \$1B eco-tourism fund launch

12:00 – 14:00

Deal Making Lunches

- Country-specific investment round-tables
- Startup pitch battles judged by:
 - International investors
 - Venture capital funds
 - Development finance partners

14:00 – 15:30

Commerce Wars Panel

Theme: "AfCFTA vs US/China Trade Blocs"

Speakers:

- Multilateralism
- Trade policy expert - AGOA renewal
- - BRI priorities

Action : Live poll on trade alliance preferences

15:30 – 17:00

Future Sessions

AGRICULTURE

Lab-grown meat demo by

MINERALS

Frontier innovation in space & mining talk

HEALTH

AI diagnostics showcase by

INFRASTRUCTURE

Hyperloop prototype reveal

TOURISM

Virtual reality safari experience

15:30 – 17:00

Closing Deal Rally

- Rapid-fire deal announcements (2 mins each)
- Africa Investment Scoreboard reveal
- "Unicorn Cup" award for top startup

18:30+

Cultural Closing

- Live art auction featuring African futurism
- Afrobeats beach party

Speakers



H.E Rosalia Arteaga

Former President
of Ecuador



H.E Ameenah Gurib-Fakim

H.E Ameenah Gurib-Fakim,
Former President of Mauritius
Honorary Chair of the AWF



H.E Ana-Helena Chacón

Former Vice President,
Costa-Rica
Honorary Chair of the
AEF Diplomatic Club



**Hon. Abraham
Dwuma Odoo**

Agriculture Expert, Former Ghana
Member of Parliament & Deputy
Minister



Yassin Al Suroor

AEF Senior Advisor
strategic Partnerships &
Economic Diplomacy
(Global & Africa).



NJ Ayuk

Executive Chairman,
African Energy Chamber



Dr. Bu Abdullah

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